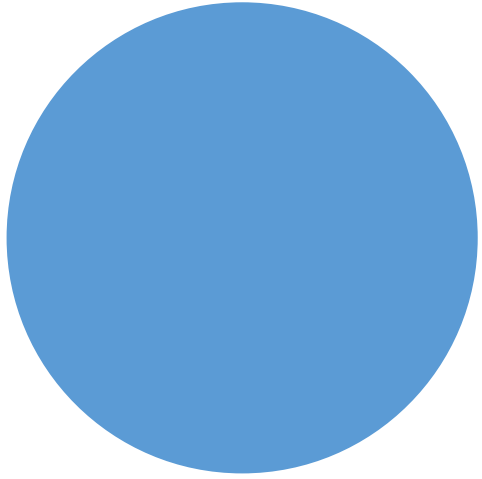


Fish You Can
Catch in
Ogasawara



Umeiro / Yellowtail Blue Snapper
(Very delicious ★★★★★)



[How to Catch]

Target it from the boat using a sabiki rig baited with squid or similar. Usually fished at 20-30 m depth. A midwater fish. If you don't reel up as soon as the rig hits the bottom, you'll often hook a different fish instead (Akahata or Barahata). Once you get the knack, it's relatively easy to catch.

[How to Eat]

Raw (sashimi, skin-blached sashimi, seared sashimi, carpaccio, ceviche); Simmered (nitsuke soy-simmer, Okinawan salt simmer); Sautéed (butter-fried); Soup (clear salt broth, miso soup); Deep-fried (karaage); Grilled (salt-grilled, roasted)

Sujiara / Leopard Coral Grouper
(Ultimate delicacy ★★★★★)



[How to Catch]

Usually targeted from the rocky shore, living along coasts within 100 m depth. Target it with sea urchin, mackerel scad (muroaji), or shucked shellfish. Also catchable by jigging. A premium fish that is hard to catch, so always keep it.

[How to Eat]

Soup (miso soup, hot pot, clear salt broth); Okinawan salt simmer; sashimi; Sautéed (poêlé, meunière); blanched (yubiki); Chinese steamed (qingzheng); Grilled (yuan-yaki, miso-marinated, salt-grilled); Deep-fried (karaage)

Onaga / Ruby Snapper (Ultimate delicacy ★★★★★)



[How to Catch]

Target it at 250-300 m depth with slow jigging (jigs of 300 g or more). Standard jigging tackle can be used. A finer PE line (around #3) is preferable. (Being deep, it is easily affected by the current.)

[How to Eat]

Raw (sashimi, skin-blanching sashimi, carpaccio, ceviche); Simmered (hot pot, nitsuke soy-simmer, shabu-shabu); Soup (clear salt broth); Sautéed (poêlé); Grilled (salt-grilled)

Barafuedai / Two-spot Red Snapper (Delicious ★★★)



[How to Catch]

Often caught by casting around the rocky shore. Large ones approach 10 kg and put up a powerful fight. Not commonly eaten in Ogasawara.

[How to Eat]

Sashimi, nitsuke soy-simmer, soup, salt-grilled. Note: Caution -- some individuals carry ciguatera toxin, so be careful.

Fuefukidai / Emperor Fish (Delicious ★★★)



[How to Catch]

Often caught from the rocky shore by baiting with mackerel scad (muroaji) and fishing near the bottom. It tries to dive into the reef, so right after the hookup you must force it away from the bottom or it will snag and break your line -- be careful.

[How to Eat]

Raw (carpaccio, sashimi); Soup (clear salt broth); Simmered (nitsuke soy-simmer); Sautéed (butter-fried, meunière); Deep-fried (karaage); Grilled (salt-grilled)

*Not commonly eaten in Ogasawara

Rouninaji / Giant Trevally (GT) (Delicious ★★★)



[How to Catch]

Targeted by casting from a boat or the rocky shore. Large ones exceed 50 kg. Targeting it with mackerel scad (muroaji) may also work. A difficult fish to catch.

[How to Eat]

Raw (sashimi, ceviche); Grilled (salt-grilled); Simmered (nitsuke soy-simmer); Soup (miso soup); Deep-fried (karaage); Sautéed (butter)

*Not commonly eaten

Barahata / Yellow-edged Lyretail (Very delicious ★★★★★)



[How to Catch]

A fish that lives on relatively shallow reefs. In Ogasawara it can be caught both by jigging and from the rocky shore (with mackerel scad). A relatively easy fish to catch. In Ogasawara it is called "Chigi."

[How to Eat]

Ways to cook Barahata / Soup (hot pot, miso soup, clear salt broth, Chinese-style soup); Raw (sashimi); Simmered (nitsuke soy-simmer); Deep-fried (karaage)

*The karaage is superb!

Akahata / Blacktip Grouper (Very delicious ★★★★★)



[How to Catch]

A fish that lives on relatively shallow reefs. In Ogasawara it can be caught with jigging, inchiku jigs, soft-plastic worms, and more. An easy fish to catch. In Ogasawara it is called "Akaba."

[How to Eat]

Raw (sashimi, marinated, ceviche); Soup (chiri hot pot, clear salt broth, miso soup); Simmered (Okinawan salt simmer, nitsuke soy-simmer); Steamed (Chinese-style, sake-steamed); Deep-fried (karaage)

Kanpachi / Greater Amberjack (Very delicious ★★★★★)



[How to Catch]

Lives from shallows down to depths of 200 m and more. Usually targeted by jigging from a boat, but casting works too. Large ones grow past 30 kg. Prized for its powerful fight -- watch out for line breaks.

[How to Eat]

Raw (sashimi, carpaccio, ceviche); Soup (miso soup, shabu-shabu, clear salt broth); nitsuke soy-simmer; Grilled (salt-grilled, teriyaki, yuan-yaki, Saikyo miso-grilled); Sautéed (meunière, pan teriyaki); Deep-fried (breaded fry, karaage)

*3-5 kg fish taste better than large ones (over 10 kg).

Shimaaji / White Trevally (Ultimate delicacy ★★★★★)



[How to Catch]

Lives from shallows down to depths of 200 m and more. Often hooked while jigging from a boat for Kanpachi. It may bite better if you don't work the jig too much.

*It is sometimes caught off Hahajima, but is a hard species to land.

[How to Eat]

Raw (sashimi, carpaccio, ceviche); Grilled (salt-grilled, miso-marinated); Simmered (ara-ni trimmings simmer, nitsuke soy-simmer); Soup (clear salt broth, miso soup, Chinese-style soup); Deep-fried (breaded fry, karaage)

Sma / Mackerel Tuna (Ultimate delicacy ★★★★★)



[How to Catch]

Often hooked in the midwater while jigging from a boat for Kanpachi. Even after a full day of jigging you may land only one.

*Always keep it

[How to Eat]

Raw (sashimi, tataki, namero); Soup (clear salt broth, miso soup); Simmered (boiled, nitsuke soy-simmer, lightly-cured namaribushi); mixed rice (takikomi gohan); Grilled (sake-lees marinated, grilled belly)

Kihada Maguro / Yellowfin Tuna (Very delicious ★★★★★)



[How to Catch]

Often hooked in the midwater while jigging from a boat for Kanpachi. If you hit a school, you can catch plenty.

[How to Eat]

Raw (sashimi, tataki, carpaccio, namero, dressed/aemono); Simmered (nitsuke soy-simmer, sukiyaki, simmered roe); Soup (miso soup); Sautéed (steak, meunière, cutlet); Deep-fried (karaage)

Tsuchihozeri / Speckled Blue Grouper
(Very delicious ★★★★★)



[How to Catch]

A reef fish targeted from the rocky shore with a single-hook mackerel-scad rig. A very rare fish. Reaches about 1 m in length. It is called "Tsuchihozeri" ("earth-digger") from its habit of digging out a den in shallow sandy bottoms.

[How to Eat]

Sashimi; Soup (hot pot, clear salt broth, miso soup); blanched (yubiki)

Oomonhata / Areolate Grouper (Very delicious ★★★★★)



[How to Catch]

Sometimes caught while targeting Akahata with an inchiku jig. A fish that does not grow very large, about 35 cm in length.

[How to Eat]

Soup (miso soup, clear salt broth, chiri hot pot); Simmered (Okinawan salt simmer, nitsuke soy-simmer); Raw (carpaccio, sashimi, blanched, seared sashimi); Sautéed (poêlé); Deep-fried (karaage); Grilled (roasted)

Ishigakidai / Spotted Knifejaw (Very delicious ★★★★★)



[How to Catch]

A fish targeted from the rocky shore with sea urchin, crab, or shellfish. First scatter crushed urchin shells to gather the fish. Large ones grow to about 80 cm.

As they grow large their beak turns white, so they are called "Kuchijiro" ("white mouth").

[How to Eat]

Raw (sashimi, ceviche); Simmered (nitsuke soy-simmer, Okinawan salt simmer); Soup (clear salt broth, miso soup); Grilled (whole-grilled, salt-grilled)

*Fish around 30 cm taste better than large ones.

Isomongara / Rough Triggerfish (Tastiness unknown)



[How to Catch]

A fish caught while targeting Ishigakidai from the rocky shore. Like Ishigakidai, it feeds on crustaceans.

[How to Eat]

It has a large liver, so miso soup might be tasty?

Isomaguro / Dogtooth Tuna (Delicious ★★★)



[How to Catch]

A fish caught by jigging from a boat or from the rocky shore. Abundant around the rocky shore. Large ones grow to around 2 m. Its teeth are sharp, so be careful.

[How to Eat]

Breaded fry, meunière, marinated (zuke sashimi)

Aochibiki / Green Jobfish (Ultimate delicacy ★★★★★)



[How to Catch]

A fish abundant around the rocky shore. Target it by jigging or with a single-hook mackerel-scad rig. Large ones grow to over 80 cm. Its surface is slimy and hard to hold.

[How to Eat]

Raw (sashimi, seared sashimi, carpaccio, ceviche); Simmered (sake-salt simmer, soy-simmer, tomato stew, acqua pazza); Grilled (salt-grilled); Soup (miso soup, clear salt broth); Sautéed (butter-fried, poêlé); Deep-fried (karaage, breaded fry)

Isuzumi / Rudderfish (Not very tasty ★★)



[How to Catch]

A fish abundant around the rocky shore. It can be targeted with bait such as mackerel scad or with soft-plastic worms. You can often spot it near the surface.

[How to Eat]

Not commonly eaten.

Kappore / Black Trevally (Delicious ★★★)



[How to Catch]

A fish abundant around the rocky shore. It can be targeted with mackerel scad or lures. Even small ones fight hard, so come prepared with suitable tackle.

[How to Eat]

Raw (carpaccio, sashimi); Grilled (salt-grilled, miso-marinated); Simmered (nitsuke soy-simmer); Sautéed (meunière); Deep-fried (breaded fry); Soup (miso soup)